

I saw a weary woman the other day
sandals on as she hobbled along
her shoes scraped the rough asphalt
as she thought about the lessons life had taught

Even her thank you for letting her cross
half-raised and full of pain. Face cringing at the next ^{stop}
I continued on heading to train, but my mind remained on the emotion I
met

A gift of perspective, a lesson of some kind
It happens always, when you least expect it
For me it was a chance of gratitude
a gentle reminder to breathe and reflect
There is much hardship in this world
the weight of which you need kinship to hold
A hug, an ear, a gift or some soft words
small nice things that say 'I see you'

Empathy that breaks the pattern, picks them out of the herd
a special skill, one to be honed like a color mixed to a hue

An artist you are in the painting of reality
Sweeping that way and then the other
pulling from your palette is the key
a little love, some peace and then sometimes further
Share your hunger and stories too
Because in the end what makes a difference is this

They are you and you are them
so reach out a limb and be true